Colour for your website and business

Yes – but more as a gentle accent than as the only voice.

In business, pink is a colour that **invites closeness**, but at the same time carries a label of sweetness. It can look caring, playful, fashionable and very striking. That is why it is good to know what you are promising before you let it into your logo, website or advert.

By itself, though, it **does not attract customers** like a magnet. It can help create a **distinctive impression**, but what still decides is mainly **what you sell**, **to whom** and **how well** it all works together.

What we are telling the customer

Pink can say, for example

"I am here for you." "You can relax." "It's personal." "It's playful."

- **Tenderness and care.** Muted pink invites a slower pace and the feeling of being looked after.
- **Playfulness.** It is linked with lightness, sweets and celebration.
- **Femininity and fashion.** Today people link it with women, but that is not a law, so handle it without clichés.
- **Courage.** A sharp fuchsia says you do not want to hide.
- **Sweetness.** It can be good, but also too much. Take care that it does not oversweeten a serious offer.

Depending on the shade it also feels different. Powder and peach are **soft and personal**, old rose **nostalgic and calm**, raspberry and fuchsia **striking and self-assured**.

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Simple tips

- **As an accent, not a wall**
  It suits a logo, a button or a detail. Keep large areas light and calm.

- **Shade by role**
  Powder for care, old rose for story, fuchsia for courage.

- **Combinations**
  With wood and cream for softness, with black and white for a graphic look.

- **Cultural context**
  In Thailand it is the colour of Tuesday, in India it means the strength of women, in Europe it carries a children's label. Before you go out into the world, find out what pink means at home and where you are heading.

- **Legibility**
  Light pink text on white is almost unreadable. Use a darker shade or dark text.

- **Colour blindness**
  About 1 in 12 men has trouble telling red and green apart. Do not use these two colours as the only difference between two things.

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Professions where it is a Yes

The rule is simple. When you sell care, playfulness or the courage to be seen, pink can help you.

Care, cosmetics, massage and personal services

Muted pink can accompany a personal and gentle presentation, especially when it matches the real setting, materials and way of working. If you want to reach different people, do not derive the whole design from the idea that **care must be pink and aimed only at women**.

Flowers, confectionery and weddings

Pink can follow a real flower, icing or festive decoration. Make sure it lets the product stand out. When the website, background, packaging and photographs are all pink, **the cake may blend into its surroundings**.

Fashion, culture and original work

A rich pink can be a striking mark of recognition on a poster, on packaging or as the main motif. It does not have to be cute. With simple lettering and dark contrast it feels **direct and self-assured**.

Toys, stationery and gifts

Pink belongs with the joy of a gift and a small celebration. Try it with honest materials and clean lettering so that it does not look like one more plastic toy.

Professions where it is a No

This is not a ban for whole fields. What decides is the interplay of colour, text, photographs and setting.

- **Crisis help and accompaniment through a hard period.** An over-sweet tone can feel as though the seriousness of the experience were lost under decoration.
- **Professional and technical services.** Pink is not forbidden, but the offer must be concrete and clear. The colour alone neither guarantees nor refutes expertise.
- **Long texts and important information.** Light pink lettering on white is often hard to read.
- **Presenting food, skin or pictures.** A pink filter can distort real shades.

Try a striking shade in waiting rooms and rest areas first in a smaller amount.

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Before you send it out into the world

Show the design to a woman who does not know your offer and ask "What would you expect from such a place or service?" **Is the offer visible, or mainly the pink?** Her answer may tell you more than the general rule that pink means tenderness.

A question for you

"What should your customer feel first when she looks at your website?"

Examples from the market

You know pink from toys, from cafés and from the street. Here are **a few examples** that show what it can do.

- **Barbie (toys)**
  The Barbie doll was introduced by Mattel at the New York toy fair on 9 March 1959. Pink became so firmly tied to her that after the 2023 film people speak of the "barbiecore" style. The colour became the hallmark of a world that is not afraid to be loud.

- **T-Mobile (telecommunications)**
  Deutsche Telekom and its subsidiary brand T-Mobile use magenta as the corporate colour. According to an article in Ad Age from November 2019, T-Mobile claimed exclusive rights to this colour and defended it against similar brands.

- **Dunkin' (coffee and doughnuts)**
  The chain was founded in 1950 in Quincy, Massachusetts, by Bill Rosenberg. It began using pink in 1966 and added orange in 1980. In 2018 and 2019 it shortened its name to Dunkin'. Pink and orange is today a loud and friendly signature.

- **Lyft (ride-sharing)**
  The service began in 2012 as Zimride and was renamed Lyft in May 2013. Drivers wore big pink fluffy moustaches on their cars. In January 2015 a small glowing moustache for the dashboard arrived. Pink made a stranger's car a friendly ride.

What they have in common is that pink carries a simple message. **Close, playful, loud.** And it is mostly not everywhere, only where it should stand out.

Colours in business are not law. Studies are mixed and a lot depends on context, on customers and on how consistent the brand is. Take it as an idea to test, not as a rule. The brand examples are publicly known and the facts about them come from public sources.

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